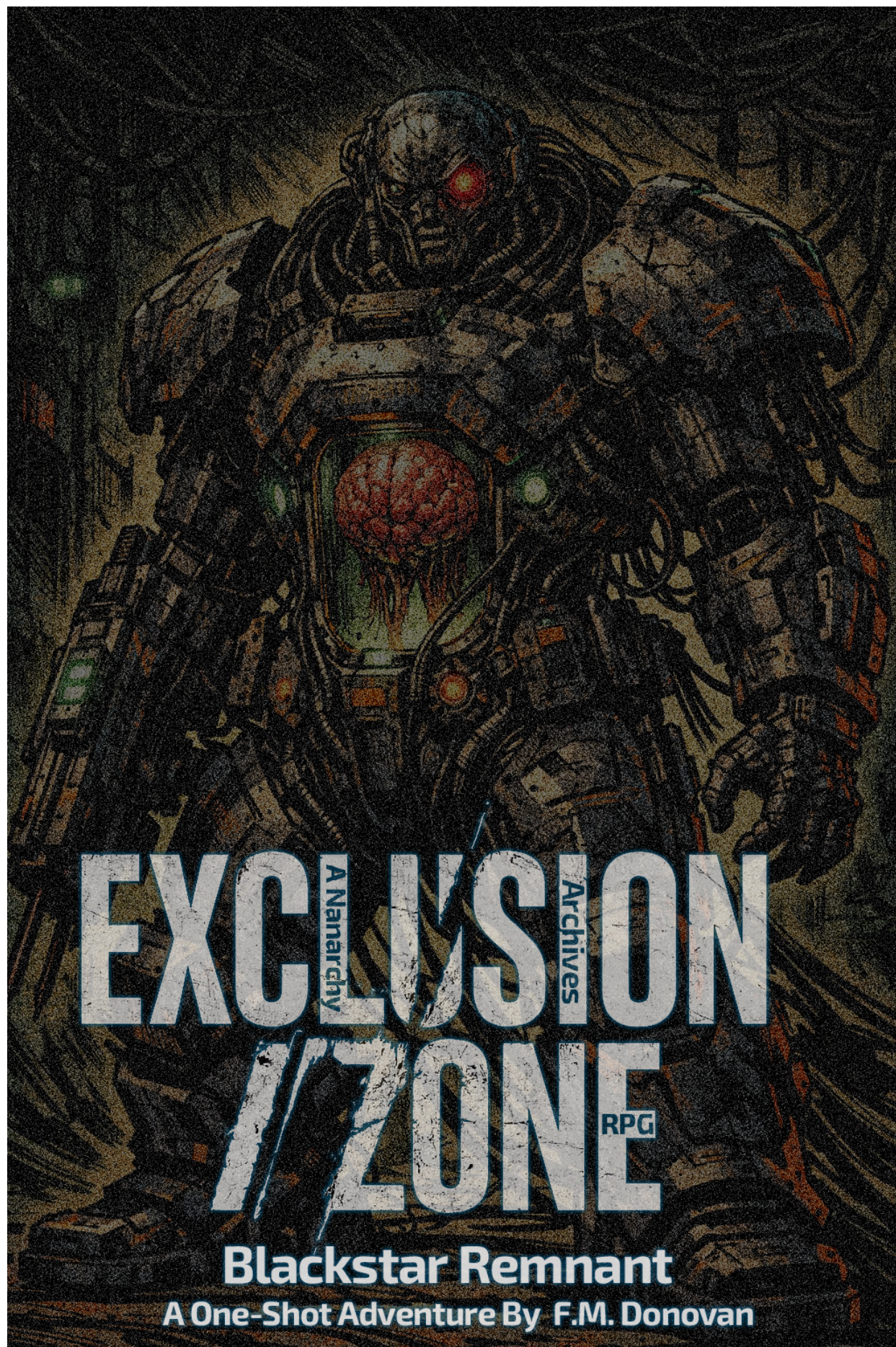




EXCLUSION ZONE

A Nanarchy Archives RPG

Blackstar Remnant
A One-Shot Adventure By F.M. Donovan



01 // INTRODUCTION

Some things were never meant to come back down.

Before the Fall, Blackstar Laboratories operated out of Archimedes—Luna’s third city—developing what they called the **Blackstar Archive**: an organoid containment system grown from mapped neural tissue. Its stated purpose was archival longevity. Its unstated purpose was immortality.

Phase 1 trials used rat-brain organoids to prove long-term cognitive stability. Phase 2—human trials—never received final approval. Terra burned first.

In the chaos that preceded and followed the bombardment, refugee surges, asset seizures, and emergency evacuations fractured every paper trail that mattered. Officially, no Blackstar Archive units ever left Luna.

Unofficially, at least one did.

By 2132, anomalous signal pings and cold-power draws have been detected in what used to be northern New Jersey—the **Bloomingdale Cluster**, a collapsed logistics and research corridor swallowed by flood damage, nanite runoff, and signal echo. Something down there is still *listening*.

Your contact is **Feedback**—memory addict, signal chaser, self-styled Databroker. He believes the device is an AI datavault containing digitized human minds. He wants it recovered intact. No scans. No questions.

He’s offering **50,000 credits**.

That number is an insult—or a test.

02 // CHARACTER SETUP

2.1 // TRAIT GENERATION

In this Quickstart, roll **1d6** for each of the four Traits:

- **Wit**
- **Intelligence**
- **Compulsion**
- **Muscle**

These values are static for this scenario. In the full system, Operators are shaped by Trait Drift and Personal Narrative—records of how the Zone has already altered them.

2.2 // SIGNATURE TRAITS & SKILLS (NOT IN THIS QUICKSTART)

Signature Traits tied to Role are omitted for brevity.

The full Skill system—including Patch, Interface, and Signal Analysis—is also excluded.

Where appropriate, the GM may allow narrative substitutions or Advantage when Operator background clearly applies.

2.3 // HEALTH AND DAMAGE

Operators are fragile by design.

- **HP = Muscle + 6**
- Most hazards and weapons deal **1d6 damage**
- Armor may reduce damage by 1 or grant Advantage on DT checks to resist injury

Damage reduces HP directly.

At **0 HP**, an Operator enters the **Dying State**.

2.8 // DEATH

“When the signal cuts, something always keeps transmitting.”

When an Operator reaches 0 HP, they do not die immediately. Instead, they enter a **Dying State**, tracked over three turns.

At the start of each turn, before any other action, the Dying Operator must make a **Death Check**.

Death Check:

Roll **1d10 + Compulsion vs DT**

- DT starts at **10**
- Each failed check increases DT by **+2**
- Any damage during this period causes instant death

Turn	Event
1	No action — Death Check queued
2	Death Check #1 (DT 10)
3	Death Check #2 (DT 12)
4	Death Check #3 (DT 14 → fail = death)

If stabilized before the third check, the Operator survives but gains **Bleeding**.

2.9 // STABILIZATION & PATCHING

Stabilization halts the countdown but does not restore HP.

- Roll **1d10 + Intelligence vs DT 10**
- On success: Operator stabilizes and gains **Bleeding**
- Failure has no effect unless the Operator is on their final Death Check

Stopping Bleeding requires further care, equipment, or narrative justification.

03 // THREATS & ENCOUNTERS

“Old machines don’t go quiet. They just stop talking to us.”

Roll **1d10** when tension spikes, players overextend, or the Zone pushes back.

d10	Encounter
1	Residual Ping: A low-frequency signal sweeps the area. Compulsion DT 7 or experience intrusive memories that aren’t yours.
2	Blackstar Marker: A scorched corporate tag embedded in concrete. Intelligence DT 6 reveals Luna-origin serial data—scrubbed but incomplete.
3	Feedback’s Eyes: A passive relay drone passes overhead, transmitting nothing. It shouldn’t be here.
4	Cold Power Draw: Lights flicker without a source. Muscle DT 7 to avoid a sudden electrical surge (1d6 Shock).
5	Data Scab: A patch of hardened nanite residue hums softly. Wit DT 6 to notice it reacting to neural activity.
6	Collapsed Refugee Camp: Burned-out shelters, personal effects neatly arranged. No bodies. Compulsion DT 7 or lose composure briefly.

- 7 **Signal Echo:** Voices repeat player dialogue back at a delay. Intelligence DT 8 confirms the echo isn't environmental.
 - 8 **Archive Peripheral:** A severed interface arm or conduit—still warm. It twitches when touched.
 - 9 **Other Operators:** A small scavenger team searching for “the vault.” They’ve spoken to Feedback already.
 - 10 **Containment Fault:** Something inside the Cluster attempts to initiate a handshake. Everyone feels it.
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// BLACKSTAR SECURITY HUSK

Class: Gamma

Origin: Corporate Asset Protection (Legacy)

Tags: Automaton, Neural-Locked, Obsolete

HP: 8

Traits:

- WIT 0
- INT 2
- CMP 0
- MUS 4

Abilities:

- **Neural Lock:** Targets with active neural interfaces suffer +1d6 Shock on hit
- **Asset Denial:** Will prioritize destruction of Archive components over Operators
- **Failsafe Loop:** At 3 HP or less, repeats last command indefinitely

Behavior:

- Patrols fixed routes

- Responds only to pre-Fall command structures
- Does not recognize modern credentials

Combat Advice: Avoid prolonged engagement. Disable, distract, or reroute.

// FEEDBACK (OFF-SITE THREAT)

Feedback does not appear physically unless the GM chooses escalation.

Abilities (Narrative):

- Signal tracing
- Memory pattern recognition
- Asset triangulation

If Feedback learns:

- The Archive is intact
- The Archive is occupied
- The Archive has been accessed

...he will move to secure it by any means necessary.

// COMPLICATIONS

Once players reach the Archive or gather sufficient data, roll **1d4**.

Roll

Complication

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | FEEDBACK PINGS BACK: He asks for a status update. Lying carries risk. |
|---|--|

- 2 **DATA BLEED:** One Operator experiences borrowed memories. Gain +1 Compulsion temporarily.
 - 3 **POWER FAILURE:** Containment systems degrade. Something must be shut down—or powered.
 - 4 **THIRD PARTY INTEREST:** Another faction converges on the Cluster. They know what this is.
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04 // POINTS OF INTEREST

The Bloomingdale Cluster is unstable ground layered over older mistakes.

1 — **Collapsed Transit Hub**

Flooded platforms and dead mag-rails. Emergency lighting flickers in patterns too regular to be random.

2 — **Blackstar Substation**

Luna-standard hardware retrofitted with Terran cabling. Someone maintained this long after the Fall.

3 — **Containment Vault**

The Archive's housing unit—sealed, powered, and quiet. The silence feels deliberate.

4 — **Interface Room**

Chairs. Leads. Dry blood. No bodies. The system logs end mid-handshake.

5 — **Signal Relay Tower**

Still transmitting. Not outward—*inward*.

05 // RESOLUTION

Actions are resolved by rolling **1d10 + Trait vs DT**.

- **Intelligence:** Analysis, decoding, investigation
- **Wit:** Awareness, perception, reaction
- **Muscle:** Physical force, combat, endurance

- **Compulsion:** Fear, mental pressure, intrusive signals

The one-shot ends when:

- The Archive is destroyed
- The Archive is secured
- The Archive is left behind
- Or someone else claims it

What the Archive contains—*if anything at all*—is at GM discretion.

What matters is this:

Once someone knows, it will not stay buried.

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